

Step Two

Separating your self-worth from your net worth

Over the course of our lives, there are various points where the world reduces us to a series of values on a screen – where someone will look at numbers correlating to decisions that we've made, both good and bad, and make an evaluation. This is, unfortunately, the way that lots of our financial systems operate – applying for car finance or a mortgage, or even to rent a home – and it causes anxiety and shame and a whole host of other unpleasant feelings. **But it does not mean that you have to do the same thing to yourself.** You know that you are more than a list of numbers on a screen or a spreadsheet. You are not your credit score or your consumer debt, you are not your savings or your investments or your pension. All of these things have the power to impact your life – to make things easier or harder, to make you feel more stressed or more relaxed – but they have absolutely nothing to do with who you are. None of these values should have the power to dictate your self-worth, and yet for so many of us, they do.